EDITION 1.0 · PRE-LAUNCH · FACTS CHECKED 9 NOV 2026

THE DAY ONE PLAYBOOK

An unofficial launch guide for **Grand Theft Auto VI** players



FREE
UPDATES
AFTER LAUNCH

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TEN DAYS. ONE PLAN.

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HOW TO READ THIS GUIDE

Most launch guides for sale right now were written before anyone played the game, and pad their pages with rumours dressed up as facts. This one labels every claim.

CONFIRMED
Stated by Rockstar, Take-Two, Sony or Microsoft.

REPORTED
Several credible outlets, no first-party statement.

RUMOUR
Speculation. Listed so you can ignore it on purpose.



Buy once, get every edition. Edition 1.1 adds first-week field notes from real play. If Rockstar changes something, you get the fix free.

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AT A GLANCE

THE FOUR NUMBERS THAT MATTER

NOV 19

LAUNCH DAY · THURSDAY

PS5, Xbox Series X and Series S. CONFIRMED

212 GB

FREE SPACE NEEDED (UP TO)

Plan for 250 GB so a launch patch doesn't block you. CONFIRMED

$79.99

STANDARD EDITION · US

Ultimate is $99.99. Same story in both. CONFIRMED

0

ONLINE MODES AT LAUNCH

Launches single-player only. Online timing is unannounced. CONFIRMED

RUMOURS TO IGNORE ON PURPOSE

RUMOUR

ONLINE ON DAY ONE

Nothing from Rockstar supports it.

RUMOUR

PC IN Q1 2027

No PC date has been given by anyone official.

RUMOUR

EXACT MAP SIZE

Any precise count before Nov 19 is a guess.

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01

PART ONE

THE FACT SHEET

WHAT	DETAIL	STATUS
Release date	**Thursday 19 November 2026**	CONFIRMED
Platforms	PlayStation 5, Xbox Series X, Xbox Series S	CONFIRMED
PC	No date announced. A 2027 window is rumoured.	RUMOUR
Standard Edition (US)	**$79.99**	CONFIRMED
Ultimate Edition (US)	**$99.99**	CONFIRMED
Upgrade to Ultimate	No price confirmed. One store listing shows $20.	REPORTED
Digital pre-load	**Opens 10 Nov.** Xbox opens at 12:00 a.m. GMT worldwide. PS5 opens at midnight in your own time zone.	CONFIRMED
Install space	**Up to 212 GB**, depending on device	CONFIRMED
Physical copies	At retailers from 12 Nov. Some are code-in-box (a download code, not a full disc).	REPORTED
Pre-order bonus	Vintage Vice City Pack + one month of GTA+ (Standard)	REPORTED
Online at launch	**None.** Launches single-player only.	CONFIRMED
GTA Online (GTA V)	Not being shut down	REPORTED
Age rating (US)	ESRB **M for Mature 17+**	CONFIRMED
Setting	State of Leonida (based on Florida): Vice City, Ambrosia, Grassrivers, Leonida Keys, Mount Kalaga, Port Gellhorn	CONFIRMED
Lead characters	Jason Duval and Lucia Caminos	CONFIRMED
Delay history	Delayed twice: to 26 May 2026, then to 19 Nov 2026	CONFIRMED

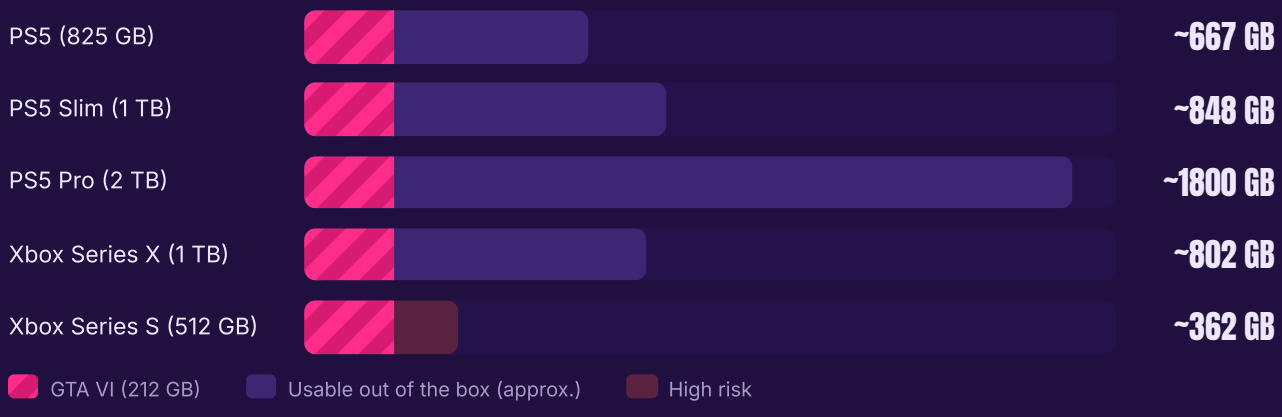
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02 THE STORAGE PLAN

PART TWO · DO THIS TONIGHT

The game needs **up to 212 GB free**, and patches arrive on top of that. Aim for **250 GB free**.

USABLE SPACE VS THE GAME



THE 10-MINUTE CLEAR-OUT

01 Sort by size
Open your console's storage menu and sort installed games by size.

02 Cut the 60-day games
Uninstall anything you haven't played in 60 days. Check cloud saves are on first.

03 Delete old captures
Video clips quietly eat tens of gigabytes.

04 Park games on USB
USB drives can store current-gen games but not run them. Use it as a car park.

! **Series S owners.**
~362 GB usable means the game takes more than half your drive. Clear space before 10 Nov, not on launch night.

¡ Usable-space figures are approximate and vary with system software.

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PRE-LOAD CHECKLIST · OPENS 10 NOV

- [ ] Pre-order is on the **same account** you'll play on
- [ ] Auto-updates on, so the day-one patch installs overnight
- [ ] Rest mode (PS5) or Sleep power mode (Xbox), so it downloads while off
- [ ] On the morning of 18 Nov, the download says **100%**, not "waiting"

03

PART THREE

WHICH EDITION, HONESTLY

OUR PICK FOR MOST PLAYERS

STANDARD

$79.99

Here for the story? Unsure? Buy this. You can upgrade later; you can't downgrade.

ONLY IF YOU'RE CERTAIN

ULTIMATE

$99.99

100+ hours planned and you want every launch bonus. Judge the bonus list on your store page, not the hype.

= **The disconfirming point.** Ultimate bonuses are extras and cosmetics. The main story is identical. Online-themed bonuses do nothing on day one.

⌂ **Physical vs digital.** A code-in-box copy still downloads the full 212 GB. Buy it for the box or resale value, not to save bandwidth.

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04

PART FOUR

LAUNCH WEEK, DAY BY DAY

MON 9 NOV
Clear storage (Part 2). Check that your pre-order is there.

TUE 10 NOV
Pre-load opens. Start it the same day. 212 GB on 100 Mbps is roughly 4.5 to 5 hours in ideal conditions, and launch-week servers are rarely ideal.

THU 12 NOV
Physical copies reported to arrive. Install from the code right away.

12 TO 18 NOV
Spoiler lockdown (Part 6). Mute, unfollow, stay out of comment sections.

WED 18 NOV
Final checks. Pre-load at 100%. Controllers charged. Day-one patch downloaded if it's out.

THU 19 NOV
Launch. Play the story. There's no Online mode to rush yet.

FRI 20 NOV
Reported **last day for pre-order bonuses** if you haven't bought yet.

HOW LONG WILL 212 GB TAKE?

50 MBPS	100 MBPS	300 MBPS	500 MBPS	1 GBPS
9.4 h	4.7 h	1.6 h	57 min	28 min

Best-case maths at full speed. Launch-week servers, Wi-Fi and other devices on your network will make it slower. Use a cable if you can.

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05

PART FIVE

YOUR FIRST SESSION

Habits that pay off in any Rockstar open world. None of this depends on unreleased mechanics, and every one gets checked against the real game in Edition 1.1.

01

GO THROUGH EVERY SETTINGS MENU FIRST

Subtitles, camera sensitivity, aim assist, HUD size, audio mix. Ten minutes now beats changing them ten hours in.

02

PICK YOUR PICTURE MODE

If the game offers a performance or quality mode, choose before you form an opinion of how it looks.

03

SAVE BY HAND BEFORE BIG MOMENTS

Don't rely only on autosaves.

04

STORY FIRST, EXPLORE SECOND

Rockstar often unlocks activities and areas through story progress. Exploring early can mean locked doors.

05

DON'T SPEND ALL YOUR MONEY EARLY

Rockstar economies have historically rewarded patience. We'll check whether this holds in VI.

06

WRITE DOWN WHERE THINGS ARE

A notes app beats your memory of a shop or hidden spot three days later.

07

TAKE A BREAK EVERY TWO HOURS

Launch-week burnout is real. The game will still be there.

EDITION 1.1

VERIFIED AGAINST THE REAL GAME IN LAUNCH WEEK

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06 PART SIX SPOILER LOCKDOWN

MUTE THESE WORDS

- GTA 6 ending
- GTA VI ending
- Lucia dies
- Jason dies
- final mission
- leaked gameplay

This is a filter list, not a hint about the plot. Nobody outside Rockstar knows the ending yet.

01 YouTube
Pause watch history. Click "Not interested" on any upload titled "ending" or "full story".

02 X · Threads · Bluesky
Add the muted words on the left.

03 Reddit · TikTok
Stay out of general gaming subreddits. On TikTok, long-press "Not interested" on the first spoiler you see.

07 PART SEVEN FOR CREATORS

KNOW THE RULES

Read Rockstar Support's *Policy on posting copyrighted Rockstar Games material*. Gameplay footage is generally allowed. **Using logos or official art to suggest you're endorsed is not.**

RADIO = CLAIMS

Licensed in-game radio music can trigger Content ID claims. Turn the radio down or off for clips you plan to post.

SET CAPTURE NOW

PS5: Settings › Captures and Broadcasts
Xbox: Settings › Preferences › Capture & share

LABEL SPOILERS

Put "spoilers" in the title and thumbnail for late-story uploads. Audiences remember who spoiled them.

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08

PART EIGHT · FREE TO YOU

EDITION 1.1

Within the first week after 19 November, this guide gets field notes from real play.

- [ ] Verified settings recommendations
- [ ] An early-game money plan, built on the real economy
- [ ] Side activities worth doing first, and ones to skip
- [ ] Corrections to anything Part 5 got wrong
- [ ] An Online section once Rockstar announces it

SOURCES · CHECKED 9 NOVEMBER 2026

Rockstar Support: *Grand Theft Auto VI Pre-Load FAQ* and *Policy on posting copyrighted Rockstar Games material*. Rockstar mod guidelines (Sept 2026), as reported by Insider Gaming, MP1st and Dot Esports. Pre-load date, time and size, as reported by VGC, Guru3D, HotHardware and Notebookcheck. Series S storage: IBTimes UK. Single-player launch scope: OpenCritic, dlcompare. ESRB rating: Vice, CheatCC. Trailer 2 details: GamesRadar, TechRadar, Shacknews. Prices are US list prices and vary by region and retailer.

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